DCS-02-8610/2024 David Ndiga

COMPUTER SECURITY ASSIGNMENT ONE

REAL WORLD CYBERATTACK

One of the most disruptive cyber attack was in Kenya July 2023 when the e-Citizen platform was attacked leading to a denial of service particularly a distributed denial of service. This was done by a group of hackers who were called 'Anonymous Sudan' who were protesting Kenya's involvement in Sudan's affairs.

They had used botnets to flood the servers with many requests causing the system bandwidth difficulties to deal with the process transactions and user authentication.

The impact of this was that public services were halted and passport applications, business registration and driving license services were affected. Financial services link4ed to the platform were also disrupted and many payments couldn't be made. Payment of prepaid electricity token purchase and SGR online booked tickets were paused.

Lessons learnt from this incident is that the government platform should undergo security audits and test under keen monitoring to be ready for such events, should have decentralized backups if the centralized platform fails since it is a single point of failure that disrupts service ,implementation of firewalls that can filter attacks before they reach the server and have a protocol in place of when such attacks happen.